latter chanced upon him at the gate. Though Babur kept wondering what made them keep him alive.

Babur drew and shot off the arrow on his thumb. It grazed Shaikh's neck. He ran down in a lane. Babur and his men followed him instantly. Mīrzā Qulī Kūkūldāsh did not seem to be forgiving. His rugged mace got hold of an enemy. He went on with his attack. One of the men took a shot at Ibrāhīm Beg but it hit Babur in the armpit instead from as near as a man on guard at a gate. Two plates of Babur's Qālmāq mail were cut. The man was coming heavy on Babur. But within a few moments, Babur was able to shoot him down. Next, Babur shot at a man running away along the ramparts, adjusting his cap against the battlements. He left his cap nailed on the wall and went off, gathering his turban-sash together in his hand. Then another man took up the fight with Babur down the lane in which Shaikh Bāyazīd had fled. Babur stabbed the rear of his head with his sword mercilessly. He bent over from his horse and then leaned against the wall of the lane. But he didn't let himself off the seat and fought Babur well.

Slowly and steadily, Babur had driven away his enemy from the gate. And then he along with his men took the gate's possession. But the challenge was still uphill for him as there were around three thousand men in the citadel against 200 on Babur's side in the outer fort. Moreover, Babur's enemy had chased off Jahāngīr Mīrzā, 'as quickly as it takes milk to boil' (proverb used by Babur). It was a substantial loss for him and with him had gone half of his men. Nevertheless, Babur sent a man, from the gate to Jahāngīr Mīrzā. The messenger was supposed to convey the message as below:[*]

> If you are near at hand, come, let us attack again.

But perhaps the matter wasn't that simple. They kept waiting at the gate for the men sent to Jahāngīr Mīrzā to come back. They returned with some distressing news— Jahāngīr had gone off long before they reached, and they couldn't trace him. Babur felt that it was a wrong decision to wait for so long. He was just left with around thirty men. Finally, as they propelled out of the gate after waiting for long and had just reached the town side of the drawbridge, several armed men came right down upon them. Banda-'alī, the father of Qāsim Beg's wife, called out to Ibrāhīm Beg and said, 'You are